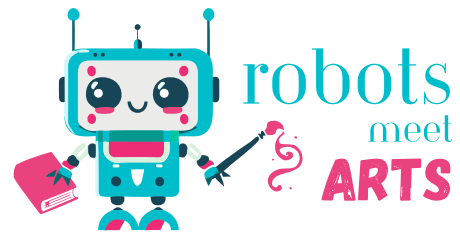




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# Dilemmas with Values: Short Stories to Think and Code

**Subject:**

Civic and moral education

**Content:**

Personal Skills

Interpersonal Skills

Social Skills

**Computational practices:  
choose what fits**

- Algorithms
- Problem solving
- Decomposition

**Unplugged/plugged:**

plugged

**Preparation time:**

approx. 30 min

**Age:**

10-12 years old

**Duration:**

4 hours

**Location:**

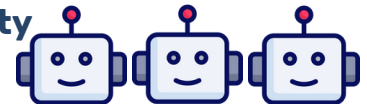
school, ICT classroom

**Group distribution:**

small groups of 3-4 students

**Difficulty**

3/3

**After this lesson, the children will be able to...**

- Represent simple ethical dilemmas through an interactive story.
  - Develop computational thinking skills (sequencing, conditionals, events).
  - Foster empathy, reflection, and argumentation skills.
  - Work on written and oral expression through dialogue creation.
  - Self-assess their work using a checklist for story elements
  - Work on the values of respect for diversity and the moral courage to stand up against discrimination.
  - Encourage empathy, respect for diversity, and moral reflection through creative expression and coding.
- 

### **Materials needed:**

- Computers with internet access.
- Access to Scratch (online or downloaded version).
- Planning sheet (project outline).
- Projector or digital whiteboard (to share projects).
- Worksheet 1: Storyboard (see Annex 1)
- Worksheet 2: Story elements checklist (see Annex 2)
- Worksheet 3: Possibles dilemmas (see Annex 3)

### **Helpful links:**

#### **Web site Scratch:**

<https://scratch.mit.edu/>

#### **Video tutorial from Scratch:**

<https://youtu.be/D-nW4jvzRr8>

## Preparation and teacher notes

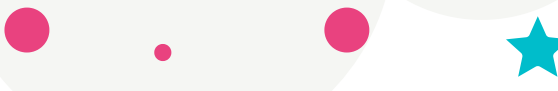
### Overview:

- This activity focuses on developing values, ethical thinking, and decision-making through short moral dilemmas (annex 3).
- Students will represent these situations by creating interactive stories using Scratch.
- The dilemma of Carla, a new student who experiences discrimination, is fully developed as a model activity.
- Each group can:
  - Work on the same dilemma, or
  - Choose different dilemmas to enrich the final discussion.

## Warm up 15'

Context and motivation: What happens in the playground? Carla is different... So What?

1. Context and motivation: "Today we're going to talk about a situation that could happen in any school. Imagine there's a new girl in your class. Her name is Carla. She's friendly, she likes reading, playing football, and she loves drawing. But... some classmates focus only on how she looks, because she wears a scarf on her head."
2. Ask guided questions for opening a short discussion to activate empathy and personal connection, without going too deep:
  - "Has anyone ever judged you for how you look or dress?"
  - "How does it feel when someone makes fun of another person?"
3. Presenting the dilemma: "One student, Nil, sees two of his friends laughing at Carla. He knows that's not OK... but he's also afraid that if he says something, they might laugh at him too."
  - What would you do if you were Nil? Would you speak up? Stay silent? Change the subject? "



## Preparation and teacher notes



### Tips:

- Test internet connection and projector setup.
- Print one copy of each worksheet per pair.
- Prepare a visual timer for pacing activities.
- Ensure all students are logged into Scratch or have access to class accounts.

## Build up 45'

Here you should guide students in developing their story ideas and starting their Scratch project.

### Steps:

1. Students **brainstorm** possible situations and ways to approach the dilemma.
  2. **Project planning:** Each group writes a short script including at least two situations where the character must choose between two different versions of the story: one where Nil takes action and defends Carla, and another where he does nothing. That way, we can see how things change based on the choices we make.
  3. Distribute Worksheet 1: **Storyboard**.
    - Students plan the beginning, middle, and end of their story.
    - Prompt them to include dialogue and narration.
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## Preparation and teacher notes

### 💡 Tips:

- Test internet connection and projector setup.
- Print one copy of each worksheet per group.
- Prepare a visual timer for pacing activities.
- Ensure all students are logged into Scratch or have access to class accounts.

## Guide

### **Characters:**

- Carla: the new girl at school, wears a headscarf (representing cultural diversity).
- Nick: the main character, unsure how to react when he witnesses injustice.
- Eva and Maarten: classmates who make fun of Carla.
- Teacher (optional): appears at the end to reinforce the message.

### **Scenes:**

1. Schoolyard.
2. Classroom.
3. Alternative endings (two options).

### **Scratch Technical Proposal:**

- Change backgrounds (Scenes).
- Add or modify 4 characters.
- Use broadcasts to switch scenes depending on the choice made.
- Add dialogue using speech bubbles or audio.
- Add sound and music to enhance emotional tone.

## Preparation and teacher notes

💡 Tips:

- Monitor groups, help with vocabulary, grammar, and Scratch blocks.
- Help them divide tasks (one student animates, one writes/records).

## Rehearsal 120'

Here you should help your students in programming, recording and rehearsing the digital story, integrating all story elements.

### Support students as they:

- Record narration using Scratch's microphone or text-to-speech feature.
- Add sound effects from Scratch's sound library or record their own.
- Test and revise story flow: backgrounds, timing, character movement, and audio.

### Distribute Worksheet 2: Story Elements Checklist.

Students review their story and check if they have:

- 4 backgrounds
- 3 characters
- Narration
- Dialogue
- Sound effects
- Character motion
- Beginning, middle, and end

Allow students to make final improvements.

## Preparation and teacher notes

### 💡 Tips:

- Test internet connection and projector setup.

## Clean up 50'

Ask groups to present their projects using the projector and speakers. Encourage the audience to listen carefully and give positive feedback.

### 1) Showcase the Projects (10–15 minutes):

- Display the Scratch creations on a screen.
- Let each group or student present briefly (max. 5 minutes).
- Encourage active listening and respect for others' ideas.

### 2) Guided Self-Assessment (5–10 minutes)

- Give students a worksheet (see below) or use visual scales with smiley faces.
- Ask them to reflect on:
  - o Did I understand the dilemma?
  - o Did I work well with my team?
  - o Did I manage to express my ideas using Scratch?
  - o Is my solution fair and respectful?

### 3) Written or Oral Reflection (5–10 minutes)

Invite students to complete a sentence like:

- I learned that...
- The hardest part was...
- Next time I would...

This can be done orally or in writing, depending on the age level.

### 4) Emotional or Symbolic Closing (Optional)

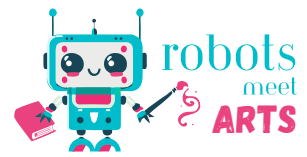
You can end the session with a gesture:

- Hang the solutions on a “Wall of Dilemmas and Values”.
- Share a group hug or a teamwork gesture.
- Write a real-life commitment inspired by the dilemma they solved.





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## Annex: Worksheet 1 - Storyboard

**STORY TITLE**

**AUTHOR**



Scene: \_\_\_\_\_

Purpose and description of the scene:

What will you need for the scene (e.g. background, narration, characters, sound, movement etc.)?

- 
- 
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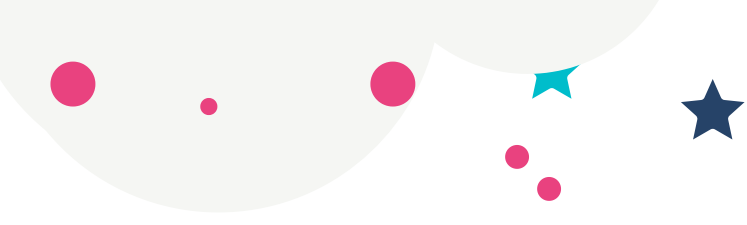


Scene: \_\_\_\_\_

Purpose and description of the scene:

What will you need for the scene (e.g. background, narration, characters, sound, movement etc.)?

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|                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  Scene: _____ | Purpose and description of the scene:                                                                                                                                  |
|                                                                                                | What will you need for the scene (e.g. background, narration, characters, sound, movement etc.)? <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>•</li><li>•</li><li>•</li></ul> |

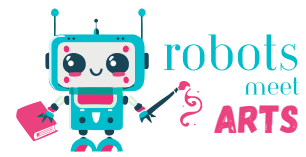
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|  Scene: _____ | Purpose and description of the scene:                                                                                                                                  |
|                                                                                                  | What will you need for the scene (e.g. background, narration, characters, sound, movement etc.)? <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>•</li><li>•</li><li>•</li></ul> |

|                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  Scene: _____ | Purpose and description of the scene:                                                                                                                                  |
|                                                                                                  | What will you need for the scene (e.g. background, narration, characters, sound, movement etc.)? <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>•</li><li>•</li><li>•</li></ul> |





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## Annex: Worksheet 2 - Story elements checklist

Use this checklist to make sure your Scratch story includes everything needed.  
Check each box as you complete the task.

### 1. Characters

- ☐ I included at least 3 different characters.
- ☐ My characters speak using dialogue (speech bubbles or recorded voice).
- ☐ My characters move in the story (walk, glide, fly, etc.).

### 2. Backgrounds (Settings)

- ☐ I used at least 4 different backgrounds.
- ☐ One background shows the title of my story.
- ☐ Each background matches the part of the story (beginning, middle, end).

### 3. Narration

- ☐ I added narration using voice or Scratch text-to-speech.
- ☐ My narration uses sequencing words (First, Then, Suddenly, In the end).

### 4. Dialogue

- ☐ Characters talk to each other using speech bubbles or voice.
- ☐ I used at least 3 different dialogue exchanges.
- ☐ The dialogue helps tell the story or show feelings.

### 5. Sound Effects

- ☐ I added at least one sound effect (e.g., music, laugh).
- ☐ My sounds match the actions in the story.

### 6. Movement & Animation

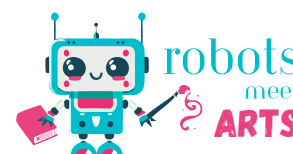
- ☐ I used motion blocks (e.g., glide, move, turn) to animate characters.
- ☐ Characters move between scenes or interact with objects.

### 7. Story Structure

- ☐ My story has a clear beginning, middle, and end.
- ☐ There is a problem and a solution in my story.
- ☐ The story ends in a way that makes sense.



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## Annex: Worksheet 3 - A set of dilemmas

Each dilemma presents an everyday situation that invites children to reflect on what they would do and how their actions can affect others.

Each dilemma is presented with a short narrative, a central question, and associated values. These situations are designed to encourage reflection, storytelling, and digital creation through tools like Scratch.

Each group can either work on the same dilemma or divide up the different proposed dilemmas, allowing for a richer collective reflection when sharing the various stories and perspectives.

### ☀ **Dilemma 1: Carla is different... So What?** (Discrimination and Courage)

Description: Carla is a new student at school. She wears a headscarf, and some classmates make comments about her appearance. Nil sees this and feels uncomfortable. Dilemma: Should Nil defend her and speak up, or stay silent out of fear of rejection? Values: Respect for diversity, empathy, courage.

### 🍷 **Dilemma 2: The Missing Snack** (Justice and Responsibility)

Description: Someone took Pol's snack without asking. Aina saw what happened, but she is afraid to speak up. Dilemma: Should she tell the truth, even if it might upset others? Values: Justice, responsibility, honesty.

### 🎮 **Dilemma 3: The Excluding Game** (Inclusion and Friendship)

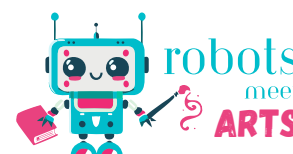
Description: A group always plays the same video game at recess but never lets Noah join because "she's not good at it." Noah notices this. Dilemma: Should Noah include her and risk conflict with the group? Values: Inclusion, friendship, fairness.

### 🔪 **Dilemma 4: Group Project Trouble** (Effort and Sincerity)

Description: Emma and Arthur do all the work for the science project, while the third group member does nothing. The teacher asks if everyone contributed equally. Dilemma: Should they be honest or pretend everything is fine? Values: Cooperation, effort, honesty.



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## Annex: Worksheet 3 - A set of dilemmas

### **Dilemma 5: The Prank Video** (Digital Respect)

Description: Alex records a prank and posts it online. Everyone laughs, but the person in the video feels embarrassed. Dilemma: Should viewers speak up or report the video?

Values: Respect, digital responsibility, empathy.

### **Dilemma 6: The Cookie** (Generosity and Empathy)

Description: You have a big cookie and your friend has none. You're very happy with your treat, but you know your friend is hungry. Dilemma: Would you share the cookie or eat it all by yourself? Values: Generosity, empathy, solidarity.

### **Dilemma 7: Help or Study?** (Support and Responsibility)

Description: A classmate struggles with a math task. You studied well, but helping might cost you time to prepare for your own test. Dilemma: Would you help or focus on your own revision? Values: Cooperation, responsibility, support.

### **Dilemma 8: Rules on the Playground** (Courage and Responsibility)

Description: You see classmates breaking a playground rule. You could warn them, but they might get angry. Dilemma: Would you speak up or stay quiet to avoid conflict? Values: Courage, responsibility, peaceful coexistence.

### **Dilemma 9: Honesty During a Test** (Integrity and Friendship)

Description: During a test, your friend peeks at your answers and asks for help. Dilemma: Would you help or tell them it's not right to cheat? Values: Honesty, integrity, friendship.

### **Dilemma 10: The Forgotten Toy** (Care and Loyalty)

Description: A friend leaves a toy on the playground. Another child is about to take it. You can pick it up and return it, but others might question your intentions. Dilemma: Would you retrieve the toy or walk away? Values: Responsibility, care for others, loyalty.